

Diagnostic Procedures

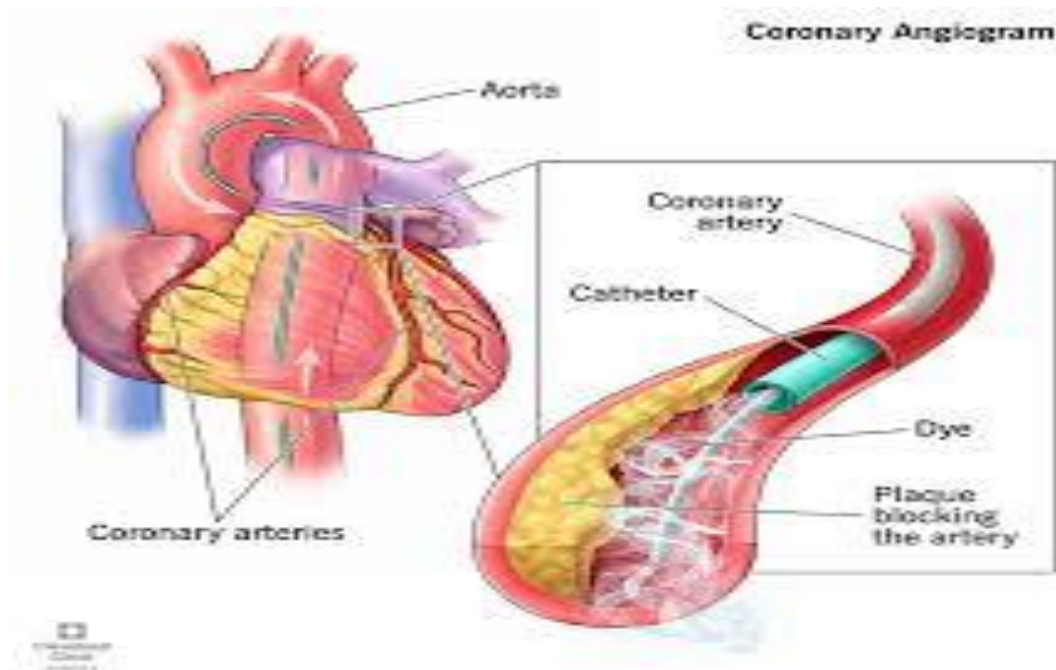
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Cardiac Procedures

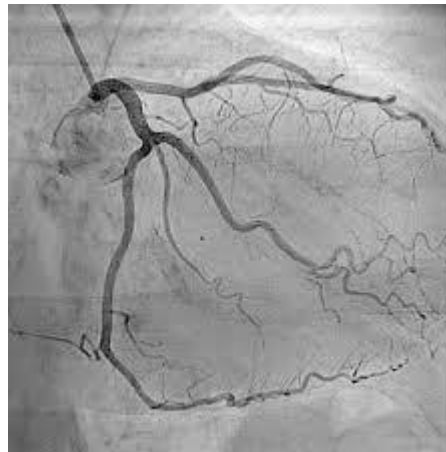
Echocardiography, also known as cardiac ultrasound, is the use of ultrasound to examine the heart. It is a type of medical imaging, using standard ultrasound or Doppler ultrasound. The visual image formed using this technique is called an echocardiogram, a cardiac echo, or simply an echo.



An angiogram is a diagnostic procedure that uses imaging to show your provider how your blood flows through your blood vessels or heart. An injected contrast material makes it easy to see where blood is moving and where blockages are. Your provider can use X-rays or other types of imaging for your angiogram.



Coronary angiography is a procedure that uses a special dye (contrast material) and x-rays to see how blood flows through the arteries in your heart. Coronary angiography is performed to detect obstruction in the coronary arteries of the heart.





Doppler ultrasound is a non-invasive test that can be used to measure the blood flow through your blood vessels. It works by bouncing high-frequency sound waves off red blood cells that are circulating in the bloodstream. A regular ultrasound uses sound waves to produce images, but can't show blood flow.

Doppler ultrasound may help diagnose many conditions, including:

1. Blood clots.
2. Poorly functioning valves in your leg veins, which can cause blood or other fluids to pool in your legs, known as venous insufficiency.
3. Heart valve defects and congenital heart disease.
4. A blocked artery, called arterial occlusion.
5. Decreased blood circulation into your legs, called peripheral artery disease.
6. Bulging arteries, known as aneurysms.
7. Narrowing of an artery in the neck, called carotid artery stenosis.
8. A Doppler ultrasound can estimate how fast blood flows by measuring the rate of change in its pitch, also called frequency. A technician trained in ultrasound imaging, called a sonographer, performs the Doppler ultrasound. The sonographer presses a small hand-held device against the skin over the area of your body being examined. The device moves from one area to another as necessary.

Ankle-brachial pressure index (ABPI) detecting for peripheral arterial disease (PAD)



64 Slice CT

This technology provides a noninvasive method to visualize the coronary arteries using a small dose of contrast. You will be referred out for this test to a radiology lab.

The new 64-slice multidetector CT scanner allows providers to analyze coronary artery lesions as well as blockages that were previously impossible to visualize.

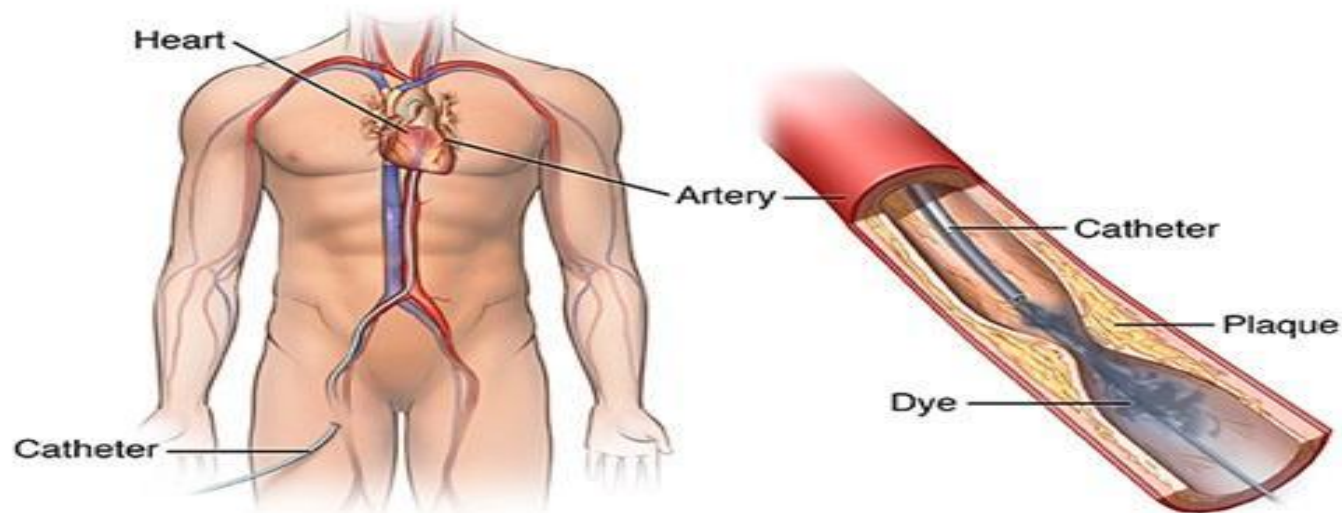
CT gathers multiple images, which acquires great amount of diagnostic information in a shorter amount of time. Unlike traditional x-ray imaging that produces a 2-D projection, CT takes thin x-ray scans from multiple directions.



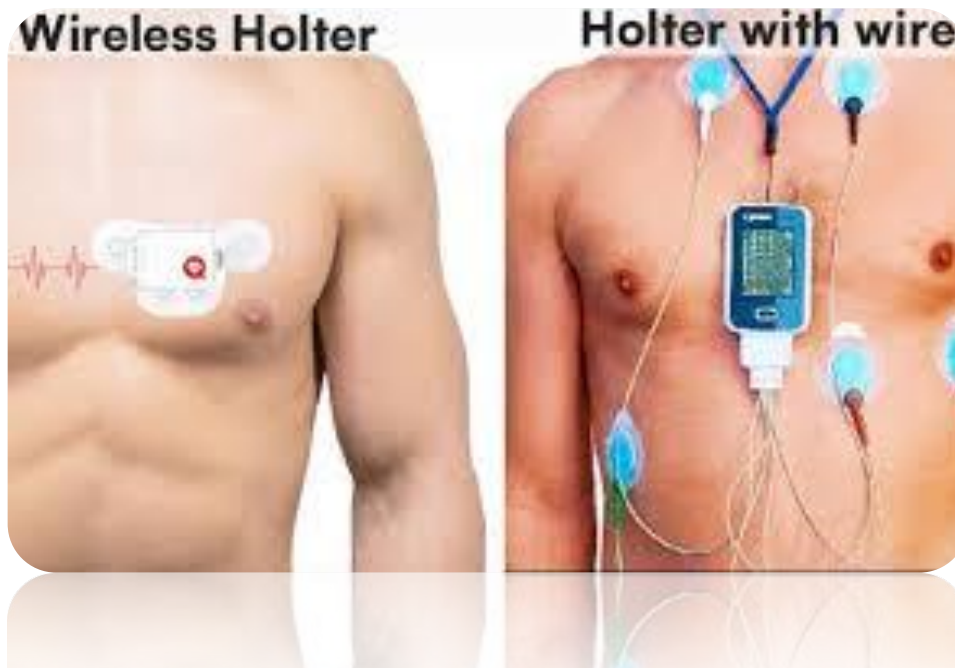
Cardiac catheterization, also known as cardiac cath or heart catheterization, is a medical procedure used to diagnose and treat some heart conditions. It lets doctors take a close look at the heart to identify problems and to perform other tests or procedures.

During cardiac catheterization, a long, thin, flexible tube called a catheter is put into a blood vessel in your arm, groin or upper thigh, or neck. The catheter is then threaded through the blood vessels to your heart. It may be used to examine your heart valves or take samples of blood or heart muscle. Your doctor may also use ultrasound, a test that uses sound waves to create an image, or they may inject a dye into your coronary arteries to see whether your arteries are narrowed or blocked. Cardiac catheterization may also be used instead of some heart surgeries to repair

Coronary angiography

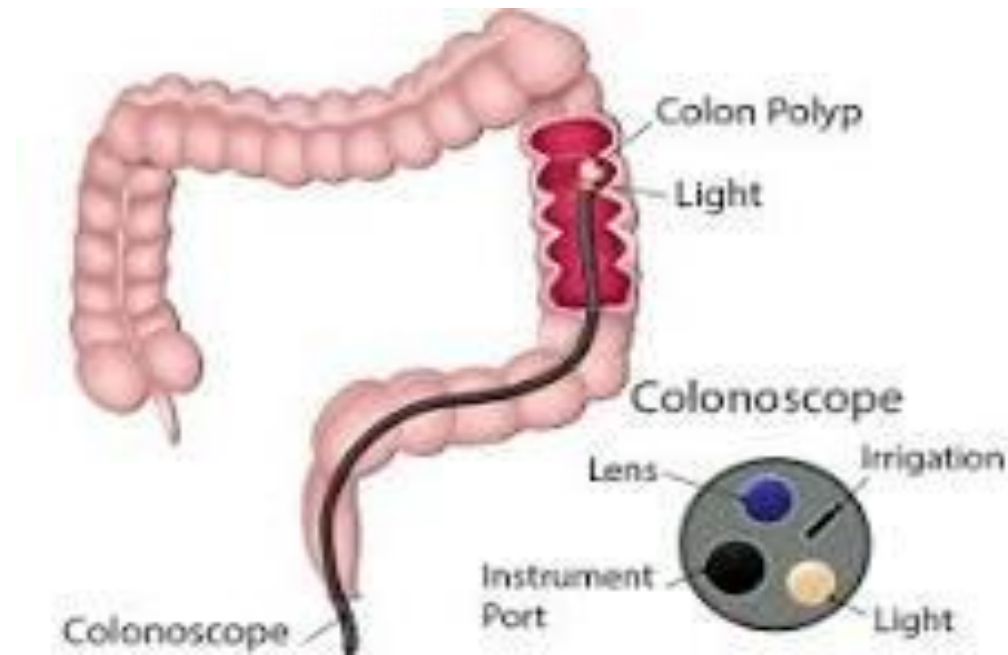


A Holter monitor is a type of portable electrocardiogram (ECG). It records the electrical activity of the heart over 24 hours or longer while you are away from your healthcare provider's office. A standard or resting ECG is one of the simplest and fastest tests used to check the heart.



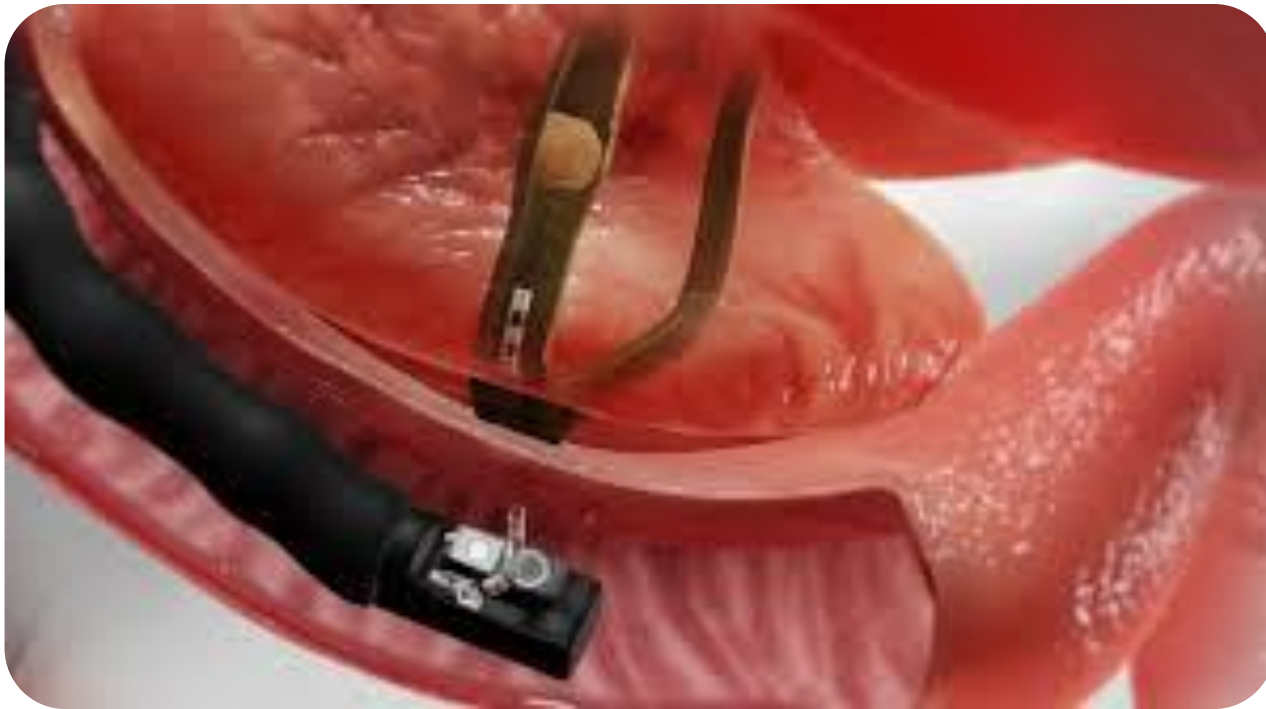
Gastroenteric procedures

A colonoscopy is a procedure that lets your health care provider check the inside of your entire colon (large intestine). The procedure is done using a long, flexible tube called a colonoscope. The tube has a light and a tiny camera on one end.



A colonoscopy may be preventive, diagnostic or therapeutic — and often, it's all of these. Your healthcare provider may advise you to have a colonoscopy for routine cancer screening if you're at a statistically higher risk of developing colorectal cancer. Since anyone can have colorectal cancer at any time without warning or symptoms, screening is the best way to stay ahead of it. While screening, your gastroenterologist may also remove suspicious tissues for testing and prevention.

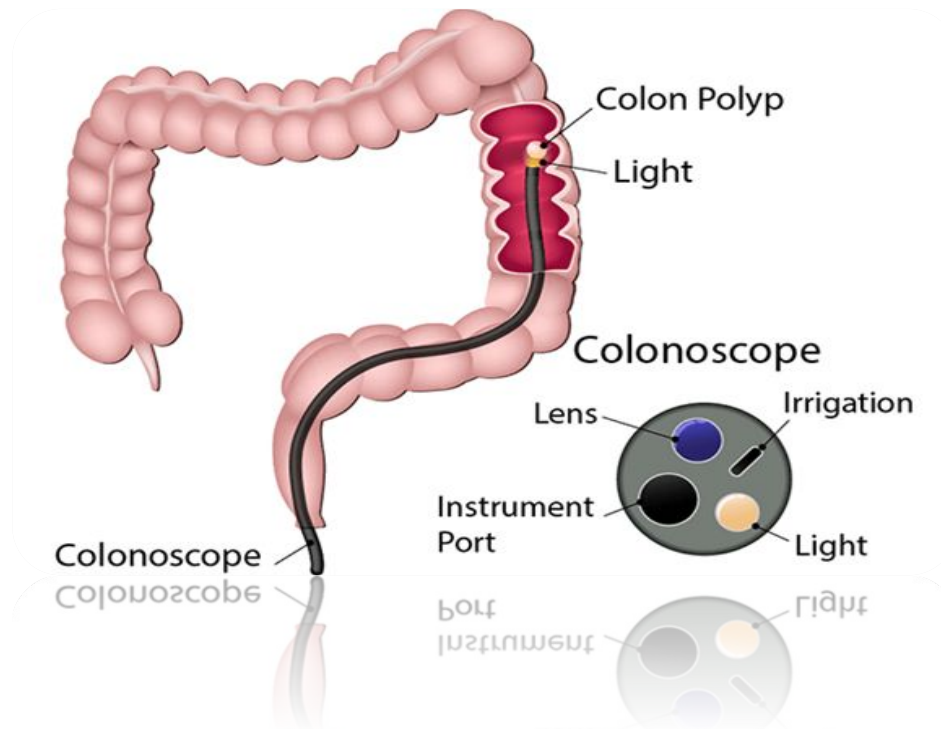
Endoscopic retrograde cholangiopancreatography, or ERCP, is a procedure to diagnose and treat problems in the liver, gallbladder, bile ducts, and pancreas. It combines X-ray and the use of an endoscope—a long, flexible, lighted tube. Your healthcare provider guides the scope through your mouth and throat, then down the esophagus, stomach, and the first part of the small intestine (duodenum). Your healthcare provider can view the inside of these organs and check for problems. Next, he or she will pass a tube through the scope and inject a dye. This highlights the organs on X-ray.



Esophagogastroduodenoscopy (EGD) is a diagnostic endoscopic procedure that includes visualization of the oropharynx, oesophagus, stomach, and proximal duodenum. It is one of the most common procedures that a gastroenterologist performs.



A sigmoidoscopy is a diagnostic test used to check the sigmoid colon, which is the lower part of your colon or large intestine. This section of your colon is close to your rectum and anus. A sigmoidoscopy can help diagnose the following symptoms: Diarrhea. Belly pain.

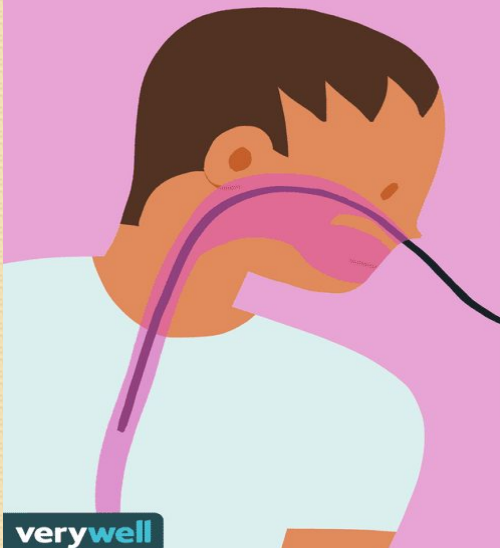


Esophageal manometry is a test that examines the coordinated muscle movement (motility) of the esophagus. The test uses a narrow, flexible, pressure-sensitive tube called a catheter. The catheter measures pressure created by the muscles in the esophagus and the valves in the top and bottom portions of the esophagus.

What to Expect During an Esophageal Manometry Test

1

Lubricated catheter inserted through nose and guided down stomach



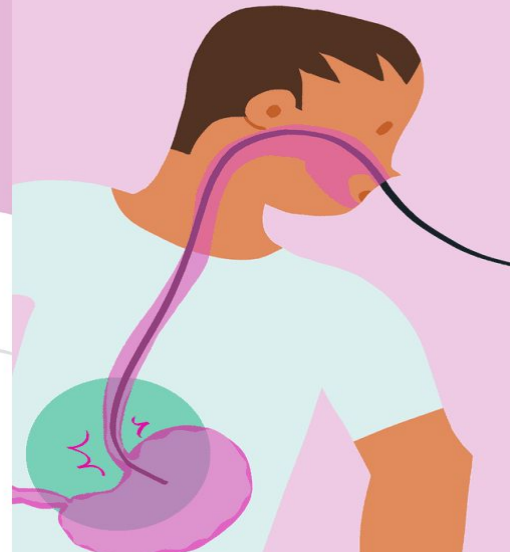
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Catheter taped in place while you lie on your side

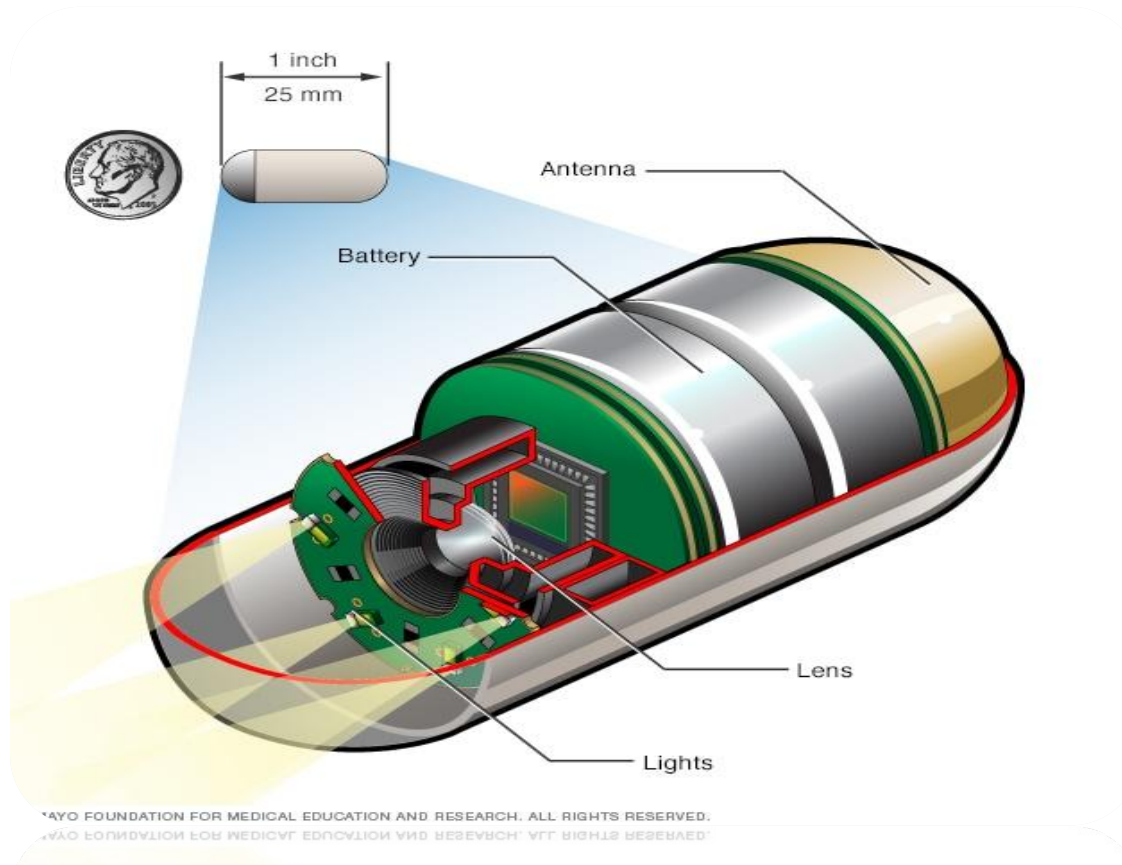


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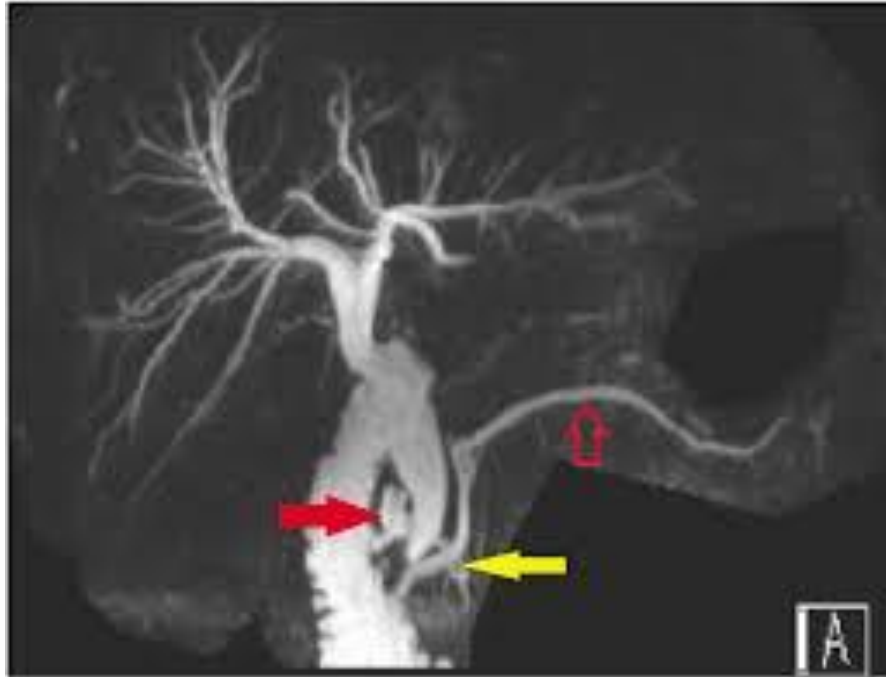
Doctor measures lower esophageal sphincter pressure as you swallow sips of water



Capsule endoscopy is a procedure that uses a tiny wireless camera to take pictures of the organs in the body that food and liquids travel through. This is called the digestive tract. A capsule endoscopy camera sits inside a vitamin-sized capsule. After it's swallowed, the capsule travels through the digestive tract. The camera takes thousands of pictures that are sent to a recorder worn on a belt around the waist.



Magnetic resonance cholangiopancreatography (MRCP) is a special kind of MRI test. Your healthcare provider uses it to look at the biliary and pancreatic system. This includes the pancreas, the pancreatic duct, the bile ducts, gallbladder, and liver.



Hysterosalpingography, also known as uterosalpingography, is a radiologic procedure to investigate the shape of the uterine cavity and the shape and patency of the fallopian tubes. It is a special x-ray procedure using dye to look at the womb and fallopian tubes



Scrotal ultrasound is an imaging test that looks at the scrotum. The scrotum is the flesh-covered sac that hangs between the legs at the base of the penis and contains the testicles.

The testicles are the male reproductive organs that produce sperm and the hormone testosterone. They are located in the scrotum, along with other small organs, blood vessels, and a small tube called the vas deferens.

